

The *Izani* Tongue

The speech of the Izan — the forest-folk of the city Iziz. Its sounds, its word-building rules, and its growing lexicon, set down so the language grows from one consistent palette instead of a contradictory pile. A soft, forest-dwelling speech.

NEW IN THIS REVISION

Everything the city of Iziz now carries on its walls, gathered back into the handbook: a **city lexicon** of 65 words coined by the rules below, 21 **place names** and 8 **sky names**, the **naming patterns** behind them, larger **tally numbers**, and every **inscription** in the city with its script, reading and gloss. New sections are marked **NEW**.

One piece of the world is now **settled**: Iziz is a forest world orbiting a red dwarf.

The rest of the **lore** and the **sky names** are placeholders, marked **DRAFT**, until the geography, history and stellar cartography of Iziz are settled.

How to read the sound charts below

Both charts are a map of your mouth. A *consonant* is placed by where you make it and how; a *vowel* by where your tongue sits and how far your jaw drops. Say each one aloud — you can feel the answer.

CONSONANTS · COLUMNS — WHERE (LIPS → THROAT)

Labial

your *lips* — feel them in *f, v, m, w*

Dental

tongue at your *teeth* / the ridge behind them — *t, d, s, n, l*

Post-alveolar

a hair *further back* — the *sh* in "ship"

Velar

the *back* of the mouth — *k*, and *ng* in "sing"

Glottal

your *throat* — *h*, just breath

CONSONANTS · ROWS — HOW THE AIR MOVES

Stop

block the air, then burst it out — feel the pop in *t, k*

Fricative

squeeze air through a gap so it *hisses* — *s, sh, f, th*

Nasal

air out the *nose* — hum *m*, pinch your nose, it dies

Liquid

air flows *smoothly* around the tongue — *l, r*

Semivowel

barely a consonant, a quick *glide* — *w, y*

The paired letters (*t d, s z, f v*) are the same sound with one difference — your voice box. Say a long *ssss*, then *zzzz*, with a hand on your throat: *z* buzzes. Voiceless sits on the left of each pair, voiced on the right.

...AND THE VOWEL CHART

Columns — front / central / back

where your tongue sits. Say *ee* → *ah* → *oo* slowly: the sound slides from the *front* of your mouth to the *back*.

Rows — high / mid / low

how far your jaw drops. Say *ee* → *eh* → *ah*: your mouth opens wider each step — *ee* nearly closed (high), *ah* wide open (low).

THE CHARACTER OF THE SOUND

Few stops, many fricatives, and a lot of liquids and nasals — so words *flow and hiss* rather than clatter. There are no labial stops (*p, b*) and no guttural *kh/gh*; that absence is exactly what makes *iz, vae* and *sel* sound the way they do. Add hard sounds only if you want a harsher dialect.

Consonants

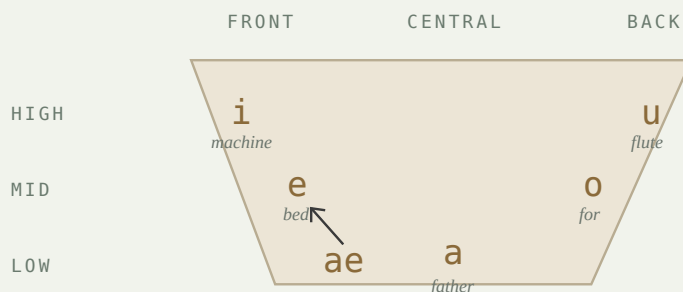
Read across for *place* (where in the mouth) and down for *manner* (how the air moves). Where a cell holds two letters, they're a voiceless / voiced pair.

	LABIAL	DENTAL	POST-ALV.	VELAR	GLOTTAL
Stops	—	t d	—	k	—
Fricatives	f v	s z th	sh zh	—	h
Nasals	m	n	—	ng	—
Liquids	—	l r	—	—	—
Semivowels	w	y	—	—	—

15 consonants. Digraphs *sh, zh, th, ng* are each one sound — the same trick English uses for *sh* in "ship."

Vowels

A vowel is just *where your tongue sits*, in two directions — so the chart is a map of your mouth. **Front** ↔ **back** (the columns): say *ee* → *ah* → *oo* and feel the tongue slide from the front of your mouth to the back. **High** ↔ **low** (the rows): say *ee* → *eh* → *ah* and feel your jaw drop lower each step. That places every vowel — **i** high-front, **a** low-central, **o** mid-back. Five pure vowels, plus one gliding diphthong; words lean vowel-heavy.



Diphthong **ae** — an "ah" gliding into "eh," as in **vae** (water). Treat it as a single vowel for syllable-counting.

How sounds combine

A tiny set of structural rules keeps every word recognizably Izani. The word-building affixes that ride on top of them come next, in *Derivations*.

(C)V(C) Syllable shape. Optional consonant, a vowel, optional consonant. **iz**, **sa**, **se** all fit. No heavy clusters — that's what keeps it flowing.

X → X-X Doubling = "a mass of." Reduplicate a root to mean a collection of it. **iz** "tree" → **iziz** "forest"; **sa** "house" → **sasa** "city." This is the rule your city name is built on.

V·V → V-l-V Linking l. When a vowel-final root meets a vowel-suffix, an **l** slips between so two vowels never collide: **sa** + **-an** → **sa^lan**. Consonant-final roots just take the suffix: **iz** + **-an** → **izan**.

Derivations

This is where a handful of roots becomes a real vocabulary. Each affix takes any root and returns a predictable new word — so you invent the roots, and the system mints the rest. Here's the toolkit, then the whole thing run out on five roots.

AFFIX	MAKES	MEANING
-an	person	one who does; person of — English "-er"
-eth	place	place of, land of

X-X	collection	a mass or body of — reduplication
-ir	tool	the instrument for doing it
-i	adjective	-y, -like, made of
-ak	causative	to make it, to cause it (verb)
-is	diminutive	little, young
-or	augmentative	great, large — the mirror of -is

Seven roots, run through the set, give fifty-six words. You’d never use them all — the grid just shows the machine turning.

	iz tree	sa house	sel hill	vae water	lith land	thur war	shae star
Person	izan forester	salan householder	selan highlander	vaelan sailor	lithan farmer	thuran soldier	shaelan astronomer
Place	izeth grove	saleth village	seleth highlands	vaeleth spring, well	litheth region	thureth battlefield	shaeleth sky, heavens
Collection	iziz forest	sasa city	selsel hill-range	vaevae lake	lithlith continent	thurthur campaign	shaeshae constellation
Tool	izir axe	salir key	selir spade	vaelir cup, ladle	lithir plough	thurir weapon	shaelir telescope
Adjective	izi wooden	sali homely	seli hilly	vaeli watery	lithi earthen	thuri warlike	shaeli stellar
Causative	izak to plant	salak to build	selak to heap up	vaelak to flood	lithak to found	thurak to wage war	shaelak to deify
Diminutive	izis sapling	salis hut	selis hillock	vaelis droplet	lithis plot	thuris skirmish	shaelis firefly

***Reading a cell:** root + affix, with a linking **l** after the vowel-final roots — so **sa** "house" + **-an** "person" → **salan** "householder." Beyond this productive set you can keep a few minor suffixes too — like **-ren** "flowing," which lexicalized into **vaeren** "river."*

Seed lexicon

Now in the three-column form: **headword** · **part of speech** · **gloss**. The middle column keeps grammar searchable and lets each entry hold several related senses, so one word does the work of many — the way real words rarely map one-to-one onto English. Same form, different part of speech, gets its own row (see **iz** as noun and verb).

WORD	POS	GLOSS
iz	n	tree; wood, timber; stick, branch

iz	v	to grow, take root; to flourish, thrive
iziz	n	forest, woods; the wilds, wilderness
sa	n	house, dwelling; home; household, family
sa	v	to dwell, live; to settle, stay
sasa	n	city, town; settlement
sel	n	hill; rise, mound; slope
selor	n	mountain; peak; the heights
vae	n	water; rain; a drink
vae	v	to flow, pour; to rain
vaevae	n	lake; pool, pond
vaeren	n	river; stream, current; (fig.) the flow of time
lith	n	land, earth; ground, soil; country, region
lith	v	to settle land; to found, break ground
lithvae	n	coast, shore; beach; the water's edge
thur	n	war; battle; strife, conflict
shae	n	star; (also) light, spark
Iziz	prop. n	the city of Iziz — "the forest"; full form Izisa
Izan	prop. n	the Izan — the forest-folk (izan "one of the woods")
Izani	prop. n	the Izani tongue — the language of the Izan (izan + -i "of the forest-folk")
-uz	suf	object marker — marks the thing a verb acts on
un	part	not — negator before the verb; also the standalone "no"
na	part	question marker — ends a yes/no question
-ki	part	that — closes a clause used as subject or object
tha	part	yes — flat affirmative
mae	adj	good, well, fine; also "thanks"
vesh	n	wellbeing, hardiness; used alone as "hello / goodbye"

POS key: n = noun · v = verb · adj = adjective · prop. n = proper noun · part = particle · suf = grammatical suffix. Derivational affixes (-an, -eth ...) live in Derivations above.

City lexicon NEW

The words the city of Iziz needed for its signs, shops, waters and walls. Every root keeps to (C)V(C) and the letters above; everything else is minted by the affixes, doubling and compounding. The fourth column shows the build, so each word can be checked against the rules.

CRAFTS, TRADE AND FOOD

WORD	POS	GLOSS	BUILT FROM
fen	n	fire, flame	<i>root</i>
fenis	n	lantern	<i>fen + -is, "little fire"</i>
kor	n	iron, metal	<i>root</i>
koran	n	smith	<i>kor + -an</i>
koreth	n	smithy, forge	<i>kor + -eth</i>
mun	n	bread; food	<i>root</i>
muneth	n	bakery	<i>mun + -eth</i>
lu	n	fish	<i>root</i>
lulan	n	fisher	<i>lu + -an</i>
luleth	n	fishmonger's; fish market	<i>lu + -eth</i>
vem	v	to trade, exchange	<i>root</i>
vemeth	n	market	<i>vem + -eth</i>
shol	n	herb	<i>root</i>
sholeth	n	herbalist's	<i>shol + -eth</i>
fel	n	cloth	<i>root</i>
feleth	n	weaver's	<i>fel + -eth</i>
zath	v	to carve; to write	<i>root</i>
zathan	n	carver, scribe	<i>zath + -an</i>
zatheth	n	scribe's house	<i>zath + -eth</i>
salireth	n	key-cutter's	<i>salir "key" + -eth</i>
vaelireth	n	cup-maker's	<i>vaelir "cup" + -eth</i>
izireth	n	axe-maker's	<i>izir "axe" + -eth</i>

WATER, BOATS AND ROADS

WORD	POS	GLOSS	BUILT FROM
nae	n	boat	<i>root</i>
naelan	n	boatman	<i>nae + -an</i>
naeleth	n	docks, harbour	<i>nae + -eth</i>
naethur	n	regatta, boat race	<i>nae "boat" + thur "war"</i>
hu	v	to wash, bathe	<i>root</i>
huleth	n	bathhouse	<i>hu + -eth</i>
dus	n	filth, dirt	<i>root</i>
dusren	n	sewer, drain	<i>dus + -ren "flowing"</i>
ten	n	road, path	<i>root</i>
tenan	n	traveller; trader	<i>ten + -an</i>
ka	v	to cross	<i>root</i>
kalir	n	bridge	<i>ka + -ir</i>
kalis	n	footbridge	<i>ka + -is</i>
rol	n	cart, wagon	<i>root</i>
norrol	n	hover cart	<i>nor "high" + rol</i>
dom	n	sleep, rest	<i>root</i>
dometh	n	inn, waystation	<i>dom + -eth</i>

BUILDINGS AND GATHERING

WORD	POS	GLOSS	BUILT FROM
dun	n	gate, door	<i>root</i>
wen	n	song	<i>root</i>
weneth	n	amphitheatre	<i>wen + -eth</i>
ron	v	to gather	<i>root</i>
roneth	n	assembly hall	<i>ron + -eth</i>
nor	adj	tall, high	<i>root</i>
thuransa	n	barracks	<i>thuran "soldier" + sa</i>

shaenae	n	star-boat, spaceship	<i>shae + nae</i>
shaenaeleth	n	spaceport	<i>shaenae + -eth</i>
hal	v	to watch, to guard	<i>root</i>
halan	n	watchman	<i>hal + -an</i>
halak	v	to post the guard	<i>hal + -ak</i>
yol	n	feast	<i>root</i>
fenshae	n	fireworks	<i>fen "fire" + shae "stars"</i>

TREES

WORD	POS	GLOSS	BUILT FROM
saliz	n	broad shade tree	<i>sa + iz, linking l: "house-tree"</i>
noriz	n	tall tree	<i>nor + iz</i>
vaeliz	n	weeping tree	<i>vae + iz, linking l: "water-tree"</i>
shaeliz	n	blossom tree	<i>shae + iz, linking l: "light-tree"</i>

CREATURES

WORD	POS	GLOSS	BUILT FROM
kir	n	bird	<i>root</i>
vaekir	n	gull	<i>vae + kir, "water-bird"</i>
sakir	n	pigeon	<i>sa + kir, "house-bird"</i>
nesh	n	cat	<i>root</i>
ush	n	snake	<i>root</i>

SKY WORDS (PROVISIONAL)

Draft — kept or replaced once the stellar cartography of Iziz is settled.

WORD	POS	GLOSS	BUILT FROM
sor	n	sun; the red dwarf	<i>root</i>
nu	n	moon	<i>root</i>
tor	n	crown	<i>root</i>

Two new habits: **compounding** — two roots side by side, modifier first, as in the seed word *lithvae* (*nae + ten* → *naeten* "boat road"); and the minor suffix **-ren** used again (*dus + -ren* → *dusren* "sewer").

Names of places NEW

Iziz names its landmarks the way it names everything: literally, in one word.

NAME	SCRIPT	WHAT IT IS	BUILT FROM
Izisa	𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌱	the city, full form	<i>iz "tree" + sa "house"</i>
Izor	𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌶	the great tree on the hill below the palace, said to be the first tree of Iziz	<i>iz + -or, "great tree"</i>
Salor	𐌰𐌱𐌶𐌰𐌶𐌰	the palace	<i>sa + -or, "great house"</i>
Shaesa	𐌰𐌺𐌰𐌰𐌱	the temple	<i>shae "star" + sa "house"</i>
Thuriset	𐌰𐌺𐌰𐌶𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the arena	<i>thuris "skirmish" + -eth, "place of little wars"</i>
Norsa	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌱	the observation tower	<i>nor "tall" + sa "house"</i>
Roneth	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the dome hall	<i>ron "gather" + -eth</i>
Weneth	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the amphitheatre	<i>wen "song" + -eth</i>
Shaenaeleth	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the spaceport	<i>shaenae "star-boat" + -eth</i>
Vaedun	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the Water Gate (south)	<i>vae + dun</i>
Shaedun	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the Star Gate (west)	<i>shae + dun</i>
Seldun	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the Hill Gate (north-east), under the palace hill	<i>sel + dun</i>
Thurvae	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the moat	<i>thur "war" + vae "water"</i>
Dusren	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the sewer outfall	<i>dus "filth" + -ren "flowing"</i>
Vaeren	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the river	<i>vae + -ren</i>
Shaevae	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the lake	<i>shae "star" + vae "water"</i>
Kalis	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the rope bridge	<i>ka "cross" + -is</i>
Naeleth	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the docks	<i>nae "boat" + -eth</i>
Naeten	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the dock road	<i>nae "boat" + ten "road"</i>
Dometh	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the waystation on the dock road	<i>dom "rest" + -eth</i>
Yolshae	𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰𐌰	the Feast of Lights, every third evening	<i>yol "feast" + shae "lights"</i>

SKY NAMES DRAFT

Placeholders until the stellar cartography of Iziz is drawn up.

NAME	SCRIPT	WHAT IT IS	BUILT FROM
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Sor	𐌱𐌴𐌹	the red dwarf that Iziz orbits	<i>sor "sun"</i>
Nu	𐌵𐌴	the green moon	<i>nu "moon"</i>
Nuis	𐌵𐌴𐌶𐌱	the pale moon	<i>nu + -is, "little moon"</i>
Kalir	𐌵𐌶𐌴𐌹𐌶	the Bridge	<i>kalir "bridge"</i>
Fenis	𐌱𐌶𐌵𐌱	the Lantern	<i>fenis "lantern"</i>
Ush	𐌴𐌶	the Serpent	<i>ush "snake"</i>
Tor	𐌱𐌴𐌹	the Crown	<i>tor "crown"</i>
Lolo	𐌶𐌴𐌶𐌴	the Twins	<i>lo "two", doubled: "a pair"</i>

Naming patterns NEW

- [thing] + -eth

a shop or workplace: mun "bread" → muneth "bakery"; kor "iron" → koreth "smithy."
- [feature] + dun

a gate, named for what it faces: Vaedun, Shaedun, Seldun.
- [kind] + sa

a building: Shaesa "star-house," Norsa "tall house," thuransa "barracks." With -or, the house becomes the palace: Salor.
- [feature] + sa

a settlement, as before: Selsa, Vaesa, Lithvaesa.
- [root] + -is / -or

given names DRAFT: Shaelis "firefly," Izis "sapling," Vaelis "droplet," Izor "great tree."

Syntax

You voted "something else," and there's a clean way to get it: make Izani **head-final** — the head of a phrase comes last. That one call answers almost everything below, and it isn't arbitrary: an all-suffix language leans right, so head-final is its natural partner. English is head-initial; going the other way makes Izani feel foreign without becoming random.

S · O · V

Verb goes last. Subject, object, then verb: **izan izuz izak** — "forester tree-obj plants."

mod → noun

Modifiers precede the noun — adjective, number, demonstrative, and possessor all come before it: **izi sa** "wooden house," **she iz** "three tree," **izan izir** "the forester's axe."

noun → P

Postpositions, not prepositions — the relation-word follows the noun: **iziz esh** "in the forest," **iziz il** "to the forest."

-uz

One case: the object. The thing acted on takes **-uz**; the subject stays bare. That's the whole case system — place and direction are postpositions. (*Kept on purpose — because the object is marked, you can shift word order for emphasis and still tell who did what.*)

no plural

Number, not plural. Nouns never inflect for number. Count with numeral + singular (**she iz** "three tree"), or use reduplication for a mass (**iziz** "trees, forest"). Base-10: **mi 1 · lo 2 · she 3 · ven 4 · tas 5 · shen 10**, built additively (**shen lo 12, lo shen 20**).

... na?

Questions. Yes/no: add **na** at the end. Wh-words (**vi** what, **ke** who, **vo** where) stay in place — no fronting: **izan viuz izak na** "the forester plants what?"

un + V

Negation. Put **un** "not" before the verb: **izan izuz un izak** "the forester does not plant the tree." A negative question just adds **na**.

[clause] noun

Relative clauses come before the noun, like a big adjective, with no "who/which": [*my-name-obj stole*] **man** = "the man who stole my name."

[clause]-ki V

A clause used as subject or object also sits before the verb, closed by **-ki** "that": [*he liar is*]-**ki claims** = "he claims he's a liar."

removed

What Izani leaves out. No articles (a/the) and no grammatical tense — definiteness from context or a demonstrative, time from an optional time-word. Fewer moving parts, and further from English.

One sentence, four features at once:

izan izuz un izak na
forester tree-obj not plant Q

"Doesn't the forester plant the tree?" — subject-object-verb, object marked, negated, questioned.

The bracketed templates use English stand-ins (man, steal, liar, pronouns) where Izani hasn't coined the word yet — they show the word order, not finished sentences.

Register & expressions

Izani's *register is blunt*. It sounds soft, but it doesn't pad. No word for "please," no polite or formal tiers, no honorifics — a request is just the bare verb (**izak**! "plant it!"), and a greeting states a fact instead of offering a wish. Short, literal, unhedged.

SAY		MEANING & LITERAL SENSE
vesh	expr	hello / goodbye — literally "still standing, hale." One word for meeting and parting.
tha	expr	yes — a flat affirmative. (Or just echo the verb: even blunter.)
un	expr	no — the very same word as "not." No softer form exists.
mae	expr	good — also carries "thanks." Acknowledgment, not effusion.
un mae	expr	bad, "no good" — and about as close as Izani gets to an apology.

Bluntness is a pragmatic choice, not a phonetic one — the sound stays soft, only the scaffolding is stripped. Useful later: an over-polite speaker is exactly how you'd mark an outsider, someone who isn't Izan.

ON SIGNS **NEW**

The register reaches the walls. A sign is one word — the place, never an instruction: **muneth**, not "bread sold here." Slogans keep the verbless shape of **un mae**: **thur un mae** "war: no good," **nesh mae** "cats: good." A topic followed by a judgement is the blunt way to hold an opinion.

Alphabet

The Izan carve, and the knife decides the shapes: every letter is straight strokes branching off a stem — a twig, fittingly, for a people whose first word is *iz* "tree." No curves (they fight the grain), no upper- and lower-case. It reads left to right.

CONSONANTS

t	d	k	s	z	f	v	th	sh	zh	h	m
n	ng	l	r	y	w						

VOWELS

i	a	e	o	u	ae
---	---	---	---	---	----

the logic

The shapes aren't random. A *voiced* consonant is its voiceless twin plus one stroke (t→d, s→z, f→v, sh→zh). Nasals stand on a *foot* at the base; liquids *l*/*r* are mirror strokes; the glides *y*/*w* fork open at the top. Vowels drop the stem entirely — open angular marks — so they read lighter than consonants, which suits a vowel-heavy language.

In your own hand, written out:

iziz — forest vesh — hello Izisa — the city NEW

NUMERALS

1 2 3 4 5

Numbers are tally-marks — the obvious thing to cut into wood — with every fifth stroke crossed. It matches the base-10 counting words (*mi*, *lo*, *she*...) without needing separate digit shapes.

LARGER NUMBERS NEW

Groups of five sit side by side, a small gap between groups, the remainder last:

7 12 23

In the city: milestones on the dock road, and day-counts painted on walls.

On the walls of Iziz NEW

Everything written in the city, in three hands: **carved** (stone and timber, the formal hand), **painted** (shop signs and boards), and **graffiti** (spray paint, the young hand). Each row gives the script, the reading, the meaning, the word-by-word gloss and where to find it.

SCRIPT	READS	MEANING	WHERE
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸	Izisa CARVED	Izisa, the city iz "tree" · sa "house"	over each outer gate, outside
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺	Vaedun CARVED	the Water Gate vae "water" · dun "gate"	over the south gate, outside
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺	Shaedun CARVED	the Star Gate shae "star" · dun "gate"	over the west gate, outside
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Seldun CARVED	the Hill Gate sel "hill" · dun "gate"	over the north-east gate, outside
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺	Iziz iz CARVED	"The forest thrives." The city motto. Iziz "the forest, the city" · iz "thrives"	over every gate, inside; the outer wall; the central square
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	iz vae il iz CARVED	"A tree grows toward water." People go where life is. iz "tree" · vae "water" · il "toward" · iz "grows"	the inside of the outer wall; the lake shore
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Izor / Iziz iz CARVED	the great tree · "The forest thrives." iz "tree" · -or "great" · the motto	standing stone beneath Izor
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Salor CARVED	the palace sa "house" · -or "great"	plaques over the palace gates
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Shaesa / izan izuz izak CARVED	the temple · "The Izan plant the tree." izan "the Izan" · izuz "tree" (object) · izak "plant"	standing stone before the temple
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Norsa / shaeshae CARVED	the tower · "constellations" nor "tall" · sa "house" · shaeshae "a mass of stars"	at the foot of the observation tower
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Shaenaeleth / shaenae vesh CARVED	the spaceport · "Star-boats: hello and goodbye." shaenae "star-boat" · vesh "hale"	at the edge of the spaceport
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺𐌹𐌺	Vaeren / vaeren vae CARVED	the river · "The river flows." (Time passes.) vaeren "river" · vae "flows"	above the falls
𐌹𐌺𐌰𐌸𐌹𐌺	Shaevae CARVED	the lake shae "star" · vae "water"	on the lake shore by the jetty

ƒVƚŸ>ǂ	Dusren CARVED	the sewer outfall <i>dus "filth" · -ren "flowing"</i>	<i>over the outfall</i>
ǂVŸIƚ>ǂ Ÿ◊ǂ>ǂ W>ǂ>ǂ ƒ◊Ÿ>ǂ	Thuriset̥h · Roneth · Weneth · Vaeleth CARVED	the arena · the dome hall · the amphitheatre · a well <i>names, one word each</i>	<i>standing stones at each</i>
I II III IIII	#1 #2 #3 #4 CARVED	milestones one to four <i>tallies</i>	<i>on the dock road</i>
ǂVǂ>ǂ ǂ◊Ÿ>ǂ ǂ◊Ÿ>ǂ ƒ^ǂ>ǂ ...	Muneth · Koreth · Shoeth · Zatheth · Feleth · Salireth · Vaelireth · Izireth · Luleth · Huleth PAINTED	bakery · smithy · herbalist · scribe · weaver · key-cutter · cup-maker · axe-maker · fishmonger · bathhouse <i>[thing] + -eth</i>	<i>shop signs over doors</i>
ǂVŸ^ǂƚ^ ƒ>ǂ>ǂ ǂ^ŸIƚ ƒ◊ǂ>ǂ ...	Thuransa · Vemeth · Kalis · Dometh · Naeleth PAINTED	barracks · market · footbridge · inn · docks <i>names, one word each</i>	<i>boards and signs</i>
Ÿ◊Ÿǂ◊	Yolshae PAINTED	the Feast of Lights <i>yol "feast" · shae "lights"</i>	<i>festival posters, the day before and the day of</i>
ǂVŸVǂǂ◊	thur un mae GRAFFITI	"War: no good." <i>thur "war" · un mae "no good"</i>	<i>walls</i>
+^Ÿ^ǂVǂǂ◊	halan un mae GRAFFITI	"Watchmen: no good." <i>halan "watchman" · un mae "no good"</i>	<i>walls</i>
ǂVǂVǂ	mun un GRAFFITI	"No bread." <i>mun "bread" · un "no"</i>	<i>walls</i>
ǂ>ǂǂ◊	nesh mae GRAFFITI	"Cats: good." <i>nesh "cat" · mae "good"</i>	<i>walls; the dock warehouse</i>
ǂ◊ŸIƚ ƒ◊ŸŸ	Shaelis Izor GRAFFITI	two names side by side <i>Shaelis "firefly" · Izor "great tree"</i>	<i>walls</i>
ƒIƚ ƒ◊ŸIƚ	Izis · Vaelis GRAFFITI	name tags: "sapling", "droplet" <i>iz, vae + -is</i>	<i>walls</i>
𐌹𐌹𐌹 II	#12 GRAFFITI	a count of days <i>tallies</i>	<i>walls; gate passages</i>

The world SETTLED

Iziz is a forest world orbiting a red dwarf. Its light is low and red; the forest covers almost everything, and the city grew up inside it rather than in a clearing cut from it. Old trees stand both inside the walls and throughout the forest beyond them.

Placeholder. These notes were written to give the city’s inscriptions a context. They will change once the geography, history and stellar cartography of Iziz are finalised; treat nothing here as canon yet.

The Izan say their first word was **iz**, tree, and that every other word grew from it the way branches grow from a stem. So their letters are stems with branches, cut with a knife along the grain. Every child’s first carving is **iz**.

They do not say the city was built. They say it was planted: **izak**, not **salak**. The first house stood beside the first tree, which is why the full name, **Izisa**, means tree-house. That tree, **Izor**, still stands on the hill below the Salor; the old trees inside the walls (**saliz**, **noriz**, **vaeliz**, **shaeliz**) are never cut. **Iziz iz** is cut over the inside of every gate.

Three gates open on the world: **Vaedun** faces south towards Vaeren and the lake, **Shaedun** faces west towards the evening sky, and **Seldun** faces north-east under the palace hill. The doors drop at night, and the watchmen, **halan**, are posted (**halak**) at dawn and dusk.

The walls are as blunt as the speech. A sign is one word, the place: **muneth**, **koreth**. There are no signs that ask or warn, because there is no word for please. Paint is for the young: soldiers’ children write **thur un mae**, and lovers paint two names side by side. Given names often take **-is** or **-or**: **Shaelis**, **Izor**.

Above the city: **Sor**, the red dwarf; **Nu**, the green moon, waxing and waning over eight days; **Nuis**, the pale moon, crossing every twenty hours. The carvers name five figures: **Kalir**, **Fenis**, **Ush**, **Tor** and **Lolo**.

Every third evening is **Yolshae**, with **fenshae** over the Shaesa. On feast days the boatmen race (**naethur**) on **Shaevae**, the star-water. Its water leaves as **Vaeren**, and at the falls the carvers wrote **vaeren vae**: time passes. Trade comes up **Naeten**, the boat road, from **Naeleth** to the Water Gate; travellers sleep at **Dometh**. The moat is **Thurvae**, war-water.

FOR REFERENCE

English, on the same grid

The same method, filled in with a language you already speak — so you can sanity-check the chart against your own mouth. Two things jump out: English crams far more sounds into the same map, and it uses a whole row Iziz doesn’t — affricates, a stop and a fricative fused together (the *ch* in "church," the *j* in "judge").

	LABIAL	DENTAL	POST - ALV .	VELAR	GLOTTAL
Stops	p b	t d	—	k g	—
Affricates	—	—	c h j	—	—
Fricatives	f v	th s z	sh zh	—	h
Nasals	m	n	—	ng	—
Liquids	—	l r	—	—	—
Semivowels	w	—	y	—	—

Sound cues: ch "church" · j "judge" · sh "ship" · zh "measure" · th "thin" & "this" (English writes both with one spelling) · ng "sing." ~24 consonants, against Iziz's 15.

	FRONT	CENTRAL	BACK
High	ee "see"	—	oo "boot"
Mid	e "bed"	uh "sofa"	aw "born"
Low	a "cat"	ah "father"	—

And that's the tidied-up version. English really has ~12 vowel sounds (plus diphthongs, like the i in "ride") crammed into 5 written letters, with spelling that rarely matches sound. That mismatch is exactly the headache your clean 5-vowel system sidesteps.

To extend it: coin new roots that obey (C)V(C) and use only the letters above — then let doubling, -or and -ren do the derivation. Name any settlement with [feature] + sa: Selsa (hill-town), Vaevaesa → Vaesa (lake-town), Lithvaesa (coast-town). **NEW** Name a shop with [thing] + -eth, a gate with [feature] + dun.